

Episode 10: Special Episode... I'm in Seoul

Since yesterday (Monday), I've been in Seoul, Korea. For meetings regarding the work I'm currently participating in, *Taichi Senjimon* (太極千字文).

This work is a TV series for Korean broadcast, where the Japanese side (Toei Animation) handles everything from scenarios to storyboards and character/art designs, while Korean production companies handle the actual animation production work. Yes, it's "collaborative work."

Based on the setting materials we Japanese staff created, the Korean side cooks and expands everything to complete it for broadcast.

First, broadcast in Korea is scheduled to start in April, and production is already well underway. This meeting is for various confirmations and considerations of questions and requests from each part - direction, animation, etc.

The group includes producer, director, character designer, mecha designer, and others - 8 people total. Until tomorrow (Wednesday), it'll be quite a dense Seoul stay.

Our group that arrived in Seoul at noon immediately went to the production site after lunch with the production company people who came to meet us.

The location is in a newly developed district in one corner of Seoul city. Many glass-walled high-rise office buildings stand in rows. Many Korean animation production companies have gathered in this district, all located in these high-rise office buildings. Man, it's completely different from Japan (laughs).

But once you step into the studio, it's still an anime production site. Mountains of piled cut bags, posters on walls, staff working at desks and monitors, and staff napping on folding beds nearby. Ah, it's the same (laughs).

After a general tour, Korean and Japanese staff gathered in a meeting room to start discussions. We had passionate meetings for nearly 5 hours, far exceeding the originally planned time. After all, communication between staff is fundamental to anime production. It's fun meeting and talking with site staff. I was considering giving up this business trip because of all the difficult work I'm carrying, but man, I'm glad I came!

Today, the second day, after observing the dubbing site, we returned to the studio for more meetings.

This *Taichi Senjimon* broadcast in Japan is still undecided, but I hope broadcast in Japan gets decided soon.

So sorry, this time was such a Seoul business trip diary (sweat).

(07.03.13)